

## TRADITION, ITS DIVINE AND DISTORTED ASPECTS

My beloved friends, God's blessings are given. The presence of Christ is here, always with you. Reach out so that you can be helped where you need it most when in disharmony and disturbance, of whatever nature.

Many of you find yourself in turmoil because you feel that I now "bring in" Jesus Christ. But this is an error in your perception, because I always talked about His existence from the very beginning of my task with you. There was a period in which we had to emphasize your own inner processes. You had to learn the subtlety of the unconscious processes in order to explore yourself in depth. Only then can a commitment to and belief in God and all His aspects become meaningful. Only then can you find out God's truth rather than superimposing a belief on top of whatever material there may exist that you need to deal with.

My friends, I am a spirit of truth and I would not, could never lead you astray. If I speak of Jesus Christ's reality, which is an aspect of God's reality, I do so only because you no longer need erect barriers of any sort. These barriers can take many forms. For many years we have worked with the barriers of plain ordinary lower self attitudes and traits. Now we deal with barriers of a more subtle nature. All I am asking you to do is open yourself up for new considerations and possibilities, not to blindly accept my words. If my words are not truth, you should not accept them. But if they are, you must not barricade yourself against them. For whatever truth exists is necessary to know, to grasp, to experience for your own fulfillment of all of your potentials in being who you ultimately are.

The topic of this lecture, as I have indicated, is the meaning of tradition. Let us first examine what tradition means in its best sense and then what it means when it is distorted. Many human beings have distinct images about tradition. These images trigger off conditioned reflex reactions when this term is mentioned or when human conditions reflect tradition either in its real or in its distorted sense.

In its real sense tradition means the carry-over of eternal verities, values, truths. Once a cosmic reality has been discovered and is being expressed in human life, those who experience the inevitable beauty, goodness, and rightness of it logically attempt to continue this expression. Please keep in mind that all true values of whatever nature must have been, at one point in time, a breakthrough from the world of spirit.

In order to keep this breakthrough alive, it is necessary to feel and inwardly experience the particular truth in question. Ritual celebrations can do this but are not necessarily a guarantee for this continuous aliveness. A ritual can be an empty gesture. True tradition is therefore a continuous reexperience of the breakthrough from inner worlds of other realities, a dynamic aliveness no matter

how long ago the tradition may have been formed to begin with. Tradition, in its best sense, means an adherence to eternal values, to certain aspects of them depending on which particular tradition we may have in mind.

Tradition in its distorted sense means a dead weight, a dead and meaningless carry-over. This does not necessarily mean that the specific tradition may not have contained eternal values and truths at the time it had come forth. But at the present time its true meaning has been forgotten, disregarded, mechanically repeated; and thus it has been deadened. Its reality has become flattened or even totally obliterated.

Tradition in its distorted sense can also be a meaningful truth, custom, experience that was valid at a certain time in history and under certain conditions during specific circumstances. Applying these same customs or attitudes or acts to different circumstances and conditions, where this tradition no longer has any meaning, is therefore a process of death rather than of life. The death lies in the unthinking, blind habit formation that fails to make sense out of whatever act or attitude the tradition in question signifies. Aliveness always means a thinking process, a sensefulness.

So you see, my friends, tradition can be an intensely meaningful reality. Or it can be a meaningless, dead repetition of the past that no longer has any application in the now.

Human responses to tradition exist deeply imbedded in the personality. All aspects of society are tinged by the individual's attitude toward tradition -- whether it is aware of its real sense, as explained, or whether it is distorted. Politics, religion, to name but a few, very clearly express this aspect of life.

There are those who put so much stake on tradition that all common sense is taken out of considerations about it. They believe that only what conforms to tradition, to the past, is of any value. They avidly reject any change, which is of course the most foolish attitude, for the very tradition they now adhere to, came into being by virtue of change at one time. Without continuous change, alive, unchanging verities cannot be lived. True tradition must therefore always be coupled with change. The healthy balance of the soul of the earth can be attained and maintained when tradition and change interphase in a harmonious dance.

Those who follow tradition blindly and meaninglessly create extremes of orthodoxies in religion and politics -- and of course within the human soul. It creates a heaviness and resistance to change. It springs from the misunderstood message of the soul to preserve truths, beauty, values that were given in the past as a result of the soul's struggle to find divine meaning and solutions and of the personality's willingness to overcome the fear of change.

By the same token, there are those who rebel against all tradition -- its meaningless, dead manifestation as much as its real, alive manifestation. The blindness in this attitude lies in the belief that only new findings can be of value, that all that has existed in the past must be inferior or invalid. It overlooks the fact that eternal values have always existed and will always exist and can always break through the consciousness if certain prerequisites are being fulfilled.

The new age person will neither blindly worship tradition, nor blindly rebel against it. He or she will take every specific tradition as it becomes an issue in life and examine it intelligently and self-honestly. Is there a personal stake why this or that tradition is maintained or rejected? Does living this tradition make sense now in your life -- how and why? When life's issues are examined in that way, you will attain this most wonderful flow in which you can have your traditions in the most meaningful way and make them new. Yet you will never oppose its discontinuation if it was superseded by more meaningful truths, values, celebrations, customs, or acts. You will live in this combination of being in the now because you value what deserves to be valued from the past but can also let go of it and thus create a new future, not a dead repetition of the past.

On this earth sphere you talk about old and new. Often these words carry positive and negative connotations. It can be either way. Some people think of the old as all good, all benign, unthreatening, and full of values, while the new is wrong, bad, threatening, disrupting. These are, of course, the traditionalists. Then there are those who see the old as all bad, as only outdated, while the new is totally desirable. I hardly need to point out that this again is one of these dualities which you can also transcend when you see the positive and negative possibilities in both.

On a level of deeper spiritual reality, neither one of these terms makes any sense. There is neither old nor new, and there is both. Everything already exists and always has existed and always will exist. What is new on earth is that a certain aspect of ultimate reality "vibrates through" into the world of matter. You must remember that the level of matter is a condensation of finer vibratory forms. These forms exist already in what you may call "spirit." All life pulsates, expands, and contracts. Matter comes into existence by spiritual forms pulsating "outwardly." When the contraction occurs, life withdraws and matter disintegrates. Although I have spoken about this before, you forget these ideas and do not think of your life in these terms. The more you can remind yourself and feel into this truth in your life and in your ideas, the closer you will come to being in truth.

The forms I mentioned that exist in the world of finer vibrations do not only refer to objects although it certainly includes them. There is no object on earth that does not have its origin in spirit, where it is perhaps "used" in a different way because different conditions exist, but its essence is "pulsated through" into matter and there recreates its original form in a modified way, in a symbolic way, in an adjusted way that fits the circumstances or this level of reality.

Aside from objects, we are of course dealing with concepts, abstract ideas, values, verities, laws, and so on. It is often harder for man to imagine that an idea existed in finer vibratory form before it reaches man's consciousness. All the many abstract concepts and laws I have discussed throughout the years that I am working with you on and am allowed to help you with, are realities in our sphere of life. Like objects, they too are often different in application and meaning, for you only perceive very simplified and cruder manifestations of these ideas, concepts, laws.

Returning to the concept of tradition, in our world this describes merely an aspect of a certain specific reality -- the reality of valuing eternal truth in its manifold manifestations or perhaps a certain specific manifestation. As this attitude vibrated through into your dimension of reality, it became diminished, modified, and separated from its total meaning. This is inevitable since your reality is a much diminished one in which a unity is split into a duality whereby much of the original meaning is lost or distorted. It is always up to man to recapture the original meaning and thus open

up to further influx of the levels of more complete reality. These openings occur as a result of mental attitudes and activities, of the struggle to see beyond the limited confines of your world.

The other aspect -- counter-tradition -- also exists in our world in this dimension of reality that is always ready to break into yours and thus expands your reality. It exists as the constant movement toward renewing and re-enlivening these eternal truths and laws. So the old and the new exist in the timeless reality of eternal now -- not as old and new timewise, but as concepts or attitudes with a specific meaning and expression behind them.

Let us consider the movement of your path, this particular path I have brought to you since we began a certain number of years ago. When you look back, you will not only see a certain spiral movement, which is a movement of the great life currents; in these spirals you see that there are certain repetitious phases on deeper levels, brought back with new understanding and considerations you have gained in the previous curve. Thus the old truth, learned in the previous curve, makes new sense because of the additional material you have learned. Thus what was once an entirely new truth, a revelation, becomes renewed in repetition (an old truth). But this renewal could take place only because other truths (new and old, if you will) have been discovered: new in the sense that they have been unknown by the individual, old in the sense that they have existed before.

This same spiral movement exists in the personal development and growth process of each individual. You cannot fail to see it if you observe clearly and with your full consciousness. The material of the lectures, which is the groundwork of the rhythm you follow, lays the plan for this movement that is very organically adopted to a much greater reality than you can perceive. Every expansion you have ever experienced on this path -- and there were quite a few -- always meant the incorporation of hitherto unknown (new to you) aspects of inner reality and therefore a new approach to your work. The organic movement flowed into miraculous-seeming changes of the personality in the best sense: new fulfillment and awakening of previously dormant potentials. A new abundance on all levels made itself more and more noticeable in many individuals and in your path as a whole, as an entity.

Yet how much resistance there also appeared with each innovation, with each expansion of approach, method, thinking, spiritual concept I gave you. Each such new approach or expansion of seeing the world in a new light has always created a sense of threat. You wish to hold on to the old familiar, the approach that is known to you, the confines of thinking and perceiving untouched, unexpanded. Here you follow the tradition-bound person. For in the distortion of the personality, all principles exist in distortion, just as in the purified part of the personality all principles exist in truth, faithful to their real meaning.

Each new phase is greeted with rebellion against the authority that presents you with what seems to break the tradition you have become accustomed to. Tradition is being created wherever human life takes form. This can exist on the largest social scale and on the smallest, most temporary scale. For example, the path as you have known it, say until two years ago, had established a certain tradition in which you had begun to feel somewhat comfortable. This tradition had to be broken -- renewed -- by adding new truths to it. New to you, but not new per se, for these truths have always existed. Only after accepting and trusting these new truths have they become incorporated into the body of the total work, the path. So a temporary "new" tradition came into being until the next breath of the great pulsating movement, when the life of spirit pulsated into matter the next

new/old truth, vibrated into matter that the organism was ready for. When the new/old is trusted and not being obstructed, it is being incorporated; and thus your entire consciousness is widened and expanded with that much more wisdom, freedom, and abundance added to you.

Growth is not possible otherwise. It can only exist with this movement intact as unobstructedly as possible. It must combine the old and the new. It must retain tradition and renew and enliven it.

These are eternal verities and principles that hold true for everything, for every conceivable aspect of life. I spoke about this quite generally and abstractly, but would now like to address myself more specifically to the new phase of expansion you are going through and the attitudes in you that make this expansion unnecessarily painful. In your fear you confuse issues, your thinking becomes muddled and disconnected in your very attempt to rationalize your rebellion against something new, in your attempt to maintain the comfortable confines of this path as you have known it until now. But it would not be this path if it could ever do that. The path is a movement, a journey, that comes to a halt when the movement is being obstructed. This was the fate of many spiritual, religious, psychological truths that have been filtering through into your world of matter. It is the fate of so much that once had deep value. People stopped the movement due to their fear of antagonizing those who obstruct further movement and expansion, changes and additions. They lacked the vitality to withstand opposition to further expansion and movement. This is why so many apparently entirely new organizations, orientations, schools of thought, arise constantly. The old is either being calcified by tradition in its distorted way or totally disrupted by the distortion of seeking change, seeking the new.

So far we have succeeded to keep this path on course in regard to combining tradition and change in their best sense, thus keeping the spirit pure. Of course the opposition to both these aspects -- tradition and change -- has existed, exists now and will exist. But the nucleus of this path has kept a steady balance. We pray to the Lord for His grace that this will continue.

Let us make a brief review from this point of view about the various phases of this path until now. We will abbreviate it, of course, to give just a general outline. This will help you to evaluate where you are at this present juncture. Before doing so, let us restate what this path is so as to avoid any possible confusion that may have arisen in the turmoil of your mind. This turmoil is totally artificially created. But be that as it may, you need clarification. Some of this must, perforce, be a repetition of what I said many times before. The aim of this path is to effect personal development to the utmost of the individual's potential on all levels. For this growth to take place, a variety of approaches are necessary. The mind needs to be totally emptied in the sense I discussed in connection with a recent answer I gave to a question. All preconceived notions need to be challenged and examined (change). Then some old opinions, beliefs, and ideas will be reinstated because in this open state, truth will become discernable on a deeply felt level (tradition). But these old truths will live in a new way in the consciousness of the person (enlivened tradition, renewed tradition). Other beliefs will be totally discarded because they have been found to no longer make any sense (change).

On the emotional level a similar process occurs that needs to be approached in a different way. In order to cleanse emotions and make them life-affirming rather than life-destroying, clear and truthful concepts must exist. Emotions cannot live in a void without any mental processes since

man is a thinking and discriminating creature. He is not meant to live by blind emotions. To develop his emotional nature, he needs to go through an alternating process of accepting his feelings no matter how destructive they may be. To do this, he must learn to find a way to express them without damage to himself or others. Once he has learned to accept even destructive feelings, he can begin to change them. This requires his full intelligence and mental processes to be mature so that proper evaluation can take place. It requires his physical nature to become healthy and enlivened by creative energy. Last but not least, it requires spiritual influx and help without which neither the strength nor the wisdom can exist to direct this ever changing process to flow harmoniously.

Throughout all these years I have constantly alternated in my teaching to show you these various levels and help you through guidance, inspiration, and advice how to alternate from level to level. At one time you would have to concentrate more on the emotional level, learning to accept and deal with feelings whose force you inordinately feared and denied. At other times you had to concentrate on your mental processes and images in order to recreate more realistic thought material. At other times you concentrated more on your body, to make it a fitting receptacle for truth, love, wisdom, and service. At other times you concentrated more on spiritual understanding, on a new outlook of creation as a whole and on learning meaningful prayer and meditation. Without this constant interphasing, without the inclusion of all these levels, development would be lopsided and would therefore finally come to a halt.

The aim of this path is a development of consciousness that is almost unprecedented. But there is a relatively small group of individuals in your world who is indeed ready for this evolution of their personal being, thus contributing to the evolution of your sphere of consciousness. This renewal brings about an untold expansion of personal happiness and fulfillment. Yet personal happiness and fulfillment must not be the primary aim. The primary aim must become, at one point along the way, service to the greater cause. When this happens, the willingness to sacrifice soon turns out to be the most fulfilling of life. The sacrifice appears smaller and smaller until it turns out to be that God's will is always also self-interest in the best and most far-reaching way. The Godman, the new man, evolves out of this work that includes the totality of the individual: the physical, the emotional, the mental, and the spiritual level of his being until they are all integrated into one whole, no longer separated. Thus the thinking is the feeling is the bodily sensation is the prayer. This wholeness represents the utmost of liberation, power in the best sense, individuation, and, what may appear as a contradiction, total surrender to God's will which is the individual's will.

So, this path is many things. It is a psychology, for you obviously work on your psychological attitudes, your feelings, your unconscious processes. It is a philosophy because you adopt new ways of seeing the world. It is a physical orientation because you work with your body. It is a sociology because you learn new modalities to function in your social environment. It is a new political system because you learn to combine both tradition and change in a very new way. It is religion because you learn about creation, your part in it, and your new relationship to God. It is all and it is none of these things. It is the creation of a new planetary man with new values and with old truths renewed. This new man will gradually take over and influence, step by step, those who want to obstruct this development.

When you look back on the material I brought and taught you, you will easily see that I have emphasized this alternation systematically. I have concentrated on different levels and aspects at

different times, only to come back after a certain period of absorption to the previous levels being treated. I have started by giving you an overview of spiritual reality in the most simplified way. I have then gone on to convey new concepts of thinking, most of the times aimed to bring a split-off duality into a new unity -- just as I do now with tradition and change. I have then entered into a new phase of inner, unconscious levels and attitudes. I have taught you how to experience pain, helplessness, rage. I have helped you to see and accept your mask and your lower self. I have opened up to you the vista to your higher self. I have re-entered into the spiritual realms with your thoughts and your feelings. You have worked hard along the way. Phase by phase, spiral movement by spiral movement we have followed this journey. Each phase seemed new and was always opposed for reasons that you could always find and rationalize. And also each phase was of course old, because none of these eternal truths are totally new. They may be new here in their application and combination. When your mental processes were challenged, there were always those who did not want to tamper with them and resisted. When your emotional processes were worked with, there were always those who resisted psychological therapy. When spiritual truths were discussed, there were always those who did not want religion. Each of these arguments was and is nothing but the fear of expanding yourself according to who you are meant to be, who you potentially are on an unmanifest level of reality.

At the present time, the mention of Jesus Christ elicits the same resistance that has always existed when an extended approach, an old/new truth was introduced anew. When unconscious, irrational feelings were lifted to the surface, many of you were terrified. Some friends left the path. The same happened when responsibility for the lower self became an essential aspect of the pathwork. When prayer and meditation was explained in detail and its dynamics taught so that you can use this essential tool, again many turned away with resistance and rebellion (which was always rationalized, of course). When the body was included in the total work, the same reactions came up. When different spiritual realities were emphasized (Jesus Christ is one of them), this, too, was used as an opportunity to avoid the total revision of the personality aspect, the healing of the soul. Yet none of these aspects was surprising since all of them were foreshadowed and discussed at the very beginning of my manifestation through this instrumentality. I also explained that concentration on these various levels of being will alternate and follow a certain rhythm.

As I mentioned before, you must understand that every one of these truths exists in spirit reality and is thus neither old nor new and yet is both. It is old because it has always existed. It is new because it now breaks through into your level of reality. These aspects of reality may not have the same name, for in the world of spirit names do not exist in the same way as they exist in your dimension of reality. But their essence exists and what you experience and perceive here about any and all of these approaches and realities are merely segments. For it is hardly possible to experience a total reality on your level of consciousness. This then leads to naming the thing, to creating (often false) associations to the thing, and to partial and therefore distorted vision of the thing.

When psychology made its appearance on earth, it was for you an entirely new thing. Yet in the world of spirit, these levels of consciousness are open, visible, observable, and accessible. They cannot possibly create the controversy that the appearance of psychological realities created on your earth sphere for a long time. Psychology then often came to mean an opposition to spirituality, a contradiction which is of course utterly false. So you still find this day that spiritual leaders, ministers, and priests are against psychological depth work.

By the same token, Jesus Christ has always existed. He is, always was, and always will be the divine embodiment in the universe. For many of you who strongly react in the most negative way when you hear the name Jesus Christ, this fact in itself would not, could not carry any negative and also knew that it will one day manifest as human form. Why is this fact resisted so? At one time this resistance occurred entirely due to political and power reasons, as is now prevalent with oppose them. Your personal irrational reactions to the truth of Him who was foretold by your very forefathers but then denied, is solely based on \_\_\_\_\_, which is nothing but fear of change. Thus your reactions are emotional and irrational. They do not allow a calm, open, fresh approach forefathers have erred at a certain point of their evolution. They have halted their process and interrupted the line of their inner movement - individually and as a people. This happens constantly in human development in many other areas with many different individuals and peoples. you permit for your hearts to be open to a truth that you felt hitherto disinclined to accept. But truth can only fill you when you remove the tight "knowledge" and make room for a different -in truth is indeed truth, you will limit and bind you. In either case, your liberation and your selfhood, the discovery of inner truth that is both personal and universal can only lie in this openness and willingness to let go and irrational. Real autonomy must rest upon what is cosmic and universal truth, not a personal and possibly false opinion about universal truth. mind, can only be fulfilled when you bring your personality into alignment with spiritual truth, whatever that may be at any given time of your evolutionary journey. Some of you violently struggle tragedy is that this fear is so entirely needless and unfounded, while there is everything to fear by obstructing and not even considering a larger truth that you have not allowed into your heart as yet. on my side that all of you may find the courage and wisdom, the openness and freshness to give new considerations to old truths and thus flow with the beautiful rhythm of your own inner journey so it tradition in the best sense and change in the best sense. You retain the values of the old and constantly eliminate values no longer applicable. This follows the same laws of digestion and process were not allowed. The healthy body lives marvelous apparatus of digestion, elimination, and assimilation.

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